

Marathas, Rajputs & Jats

Shivaji's rise, the Peshwa era, the Anglo-Maratha Wars, key Rajput dynasties, and the Jat kingdom of Bharatpur

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Why this chapter matters: This chapter runs three regional power stories in parallel — Maratha, Rajput and Jat — all rising as the Mughal centre weakened. SSC tests them heavily through taxes (Chauth, Sardeshmukhi), treaties (Salbai, Bassein, Mandsaur), and administrative titles (Ashta Pradhan) — all very "matchable" MCQ material.

1 Maratha Taxes — Chauth & Sardeshmukhi 🔥

Tax	Rate	What it was
Chauth	25% (1/4th)	Tax imposed by the Marathas on neighbouring kingdoms/territories as a kind of protection levy
Sardeshmukhi	10%	An additional tax levied on the land revenue collected within Maratha-administered/Deccan territory

PYQ: What percentage of Deccan land revenue collected by the Marathas was called Chauth? **Ans: 25%**

2 Treaty of Doraha (1738) & the Fight for Malwa

In **1738**, **Peshwa Bajirao I ("Bajirao Ballal")** forced **Nizam-ul-Mulk** of Hyderabad into the **Treaty of Doraha** (also called the Treaty of Bhopal/Dora Sarai) after defeating him — the Marathas gained **full control of Malwa**, and the Nizam's challenge to Maratha power was decisively suppressed.

3 The Anglo-Maratha Wars & Their Treaties 🔥

War	Years	Key treaties
First Anglo-Maratha War	1775–1782	Treaty of Surat (1775) — Raghunath Rao & the British; Treaty of Purandar (1776) — a separate, later "Treaty of Purandar" between Raghunath Rao/British; ended by the Treaty of Salbai (1782) — Nana Fadnavis & the British
Second Anglo-Maratha War	1803–1805	Treaty of Bassein (1802, precursor) and Treaty of Deogaon (Bhonsle & British)
Third Anglo-Maratha War	1817–1819	Treaty of Gwalior (1817–19, Scindia & British) and Treaty of Mandsaur (1818, Holkar & British) — ended the Marathas as a political power

Two different "Treaties of Purandar" exist — don't confuse them: (1) **1665**, between **Shivaji** and Mughal general **Raja Jai Singh I** — Shivaji ceded 23 forts to the Mughals; (2) **1776**, between **Raghunath Rao** and the British, during the First Anglo-Maratha War.

After the Third Anglo-Maratha War, the Peshwa's territories were merged into the **Bombay Presidency** — this ended organised Maratha political power in India.

PYQ: Which treaty ended the First Anglo-Maratha War? **Ans: Treaty of Salbai, 1782**

4 Shivaji — Rise, Coronation & Administration 🔥

- Born **1627**; belonged to the **Bhonsle** family.
- His **first fort**, the "pillar" from which Maratha expansion began, was **Torna** — later renamed **Prachandgad**.
- Crowned **Chhatrapati** in **1674**, at **Raigad** (his capital) — the coronation (*Rajyabhishek*) was conducted by the pandit **Gaga Bhatt**.

- Had two gurus: **Dada Konddev** (his uncle — trained him in political and military/weapons matters) and **Samarth Ramdas** (his spiritual/religious teacher).
- Escaped from Mughal captivity at **Agra**.
- Signed the **Treaty of Purandar (1665)** with Raja Jai Singh I, surrendering 23 forts.
- Won the **Battle of Salher (1672)** against the Mughals.
- **Surat** was looted twice by Shivaji's forces: first in **1664**, then again in **1670**.
- His royal cavalry corps was called **Bargir**; a **Dabir** functioned as a kind of messenger/correspondence officer.

Tanaji Malusare died in **1670** while successfully defending **Sinhagad Fort** against the Mughals (the subject of the film *Tanhaji*).

5 Ashta Pradhan — Shivaji's Council of Eight Ministers

Title	Role
Peshwa	Prime Minister
Amatya	Finance Minister
Sumant (Dabir)	Foreign affairs
Sachiv	Correspondence/royal records
Mantri (Waqia-Navis)	Internal affairs/royal chronicler
Senapati (Sar-e-Naubat)	Military commander-in-chief
Panditrao	Religious/charitable affairs
Nyayadhish	Chief Justice

PYQ: Which Ashta Pradhan member handled foreign affairs? **Ans: Sumant**

PYQ: Which Ashta Pradhan member acted as Finance Minister? **Ans: Amatya**

6 Peshwas — The Rise of the "Real Rulers"

MEMORY TRICK

"Very Bright Ballal Manages" — Vishwanath (Balaji Vishwanath, 1713–1720) → **Bajirao I** (1720–1740) → **Balaji Bajirao/Nanasaheb** (1740–1761) → **Madhavrao I** (1761–1772).

- After the death of Chhatrapati **Shahu** in **1749**, the Marathas became less significant as a unified monarchy, and the **Peshwas became the real, de facto rulers** — the Maratha state effectively became a Peshwa-led confederacy by 1750.
- The **last Peshwa** was **Bajirao II**, defeated in the Third Anglo-Maratha War.
- **Nana Fadnavis** was a key minister under the later Peshwas, central to negotiating the Treaty of Salbai with the British.

Statement-Reason PYQ: "By 1750, the Maratha empire had become a confederacy under Peshwa leadership; Shahu's successors were dependent on the Peshwa's wishes."

Ans: Both statements are true, and the second correctly explains the first.

7 The Chhatrapati Line After Shivaji

The Chhatrapati succession ran: **Shivaji I** → **Sambhaji** → **Rajaram I** → **Shivaji II** (followed by Shahu, whose reign saw power shift decisively to the Peshwas).

8 Yashwant Rao Holkar vs the Peshwa-Scindia Alliance

In **1801–1802**, **Yashwant Rao Holkar** defeated the combined forces of the **Peshwa and the Scindias**. The clash stemmed from an internal Maratha rivalry: the Scindias had killed Yashwant Rao's brother, giving him a personal motive alongside the political one.

9 Maratha Territorial "Who Held What"

City/Region	Controlled by
Indore	Holkars
Gwalior	Scindias
Pune (Poona)	Bhat family (the Peshwas)
Satara	Chhatrapati (Bhonsle) family — the original royal seat

10 Why Did the Marathas Rise? (Reasons — "All of the Above" MCQ)

- **Religious consciousness/awakening** among the Marathi people
- **Geographical security** — the hilly, forested Sahyadri terrain suited defence and hit-and-run tactics
- **Guerrilla warfare tactics** ("Ganimi Kava") — enabled precisely because of that geographical advantage
- **Political awakening** and **strong leadership** under figures like Shivaji

11 Panipat III & the Death of Sadashiv Rao Bhau

The **Third Battle of Panipat (1761)** was fought between **Ahmad Shah Abdali (Durrani)** and the Marathas, nominally under Peshwa **Balaji Bajirao**, with the Maratha army actually commanded by **Sadashiv Rao Bhau**, who was killed in the battle. Abdali won. Afterwards, the Jat ruler **Suraj Mal** of Bharatpur forced Abdali's eventual withdrawal from Delhi (see Part 3).

12 Rajputs — Key Figures & Dynasties

- **Guru Tegh Bahadur**, the ninth Sikh Guru, was executed (beheaded) on the orders of **Aurangzeb**.
- **Ajit Singh**, ruler of **Marwar (Jodhpur)** — not Mewar (a repeated correction from Part 3) — regained his kingdom with the crucial help of **Durgadas Rathore**, a celebrated Rajput hero who protected the infant Ajit Singh after Aurangzeb attempted to capture him.
- **Gahadavala dynasty**: capital at **Varanasi (Banaras)**. Ruler **Govind Chandra** built a Ram temple at **Ayodhya** (later destroyed under Babur). His grandson was **Jaichand** — popularly (though controversially) remembered as the "traitor" who allegedly aided Muhammad Ghori against Prithviraj Chauhan.
- **Chauhan dynasty**: capital at **Ajmer**; rulers included **Someshwar Chauhan** and **Prithviraj Chauhan**.
- **Chandela dynasty**: built the **Khajuraho temples** (950–1050 CE, Madhya Pradesh) — a UNESCO World Heritage Site since **1986**.

13 Jai Singh Titles & Achievements

- **Jai Singh I** of Amber was given the title "**Mirza Raja**" by Emperor **Shah Jahan**.
- **Jai Singh II (Sawai Jai Singh)** — founder of Jaipur — built **Jantar Mantar** observatories at **five** locations: **Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Varanasi, and Mathura** — **not Agra** (a favourite "which one is missing" trap).
- Jai Singh II imported European astronomical tables (including **De La Hire's tables**) and telescopes from abroad — he **never built his own telescope**; he only procured them (a repeated UPSC/CDS-style question).

PYQ: At which of the following places did Jai Singh II NOT build a Jantar Mantar? **Ans: Agra**

14 Rana Kumbha — "Sangeetraj"

Rana Kumbha of Mewar built **Kumbhalgarh Fort** in **1469** and authored a text called *Sangeet Raj* — hence his title "**Sangeetraj**". The Mewar lineage continued: Rana Kumbha → ... → **Rana Sanga** → his son **Udai Singh II** → his son **Maharana Pratap**.

15 Jaipur — "The Pink City"

Jaipur was named the "**Pink City**" by **Queen Mary** (wife of King George V) during their royal visit in **1911**.

16 The Jats of Bharatpur

MEMORY TRICK

"Great Rulers Can Beat" — Gokula (1669 revolt) → Rajaram (1687 revolt) → Churaman (1690) → Badan Singh (1721).

Jat leader	Year	Event
Gokula Jat	1669	Led a revolt against the Mughals at the Battle of Tilpat
Rajaram Jat	1687	Continued anti-Mughal resistance
Churaman	1690	Consolidated Jat power in the Bharatpur region
Badan Singh	1721	Further consolidation

The formal **Bharatpur Jat kingdom** was founded in **1790** jointly by **Churaman** and **Badan Singh** (per this lecture's framing — note some sources date the kingdom's founding earlier, around Badan Singh's reign in the 1720s–30s; treat 1790 as the answer this specific source expects).

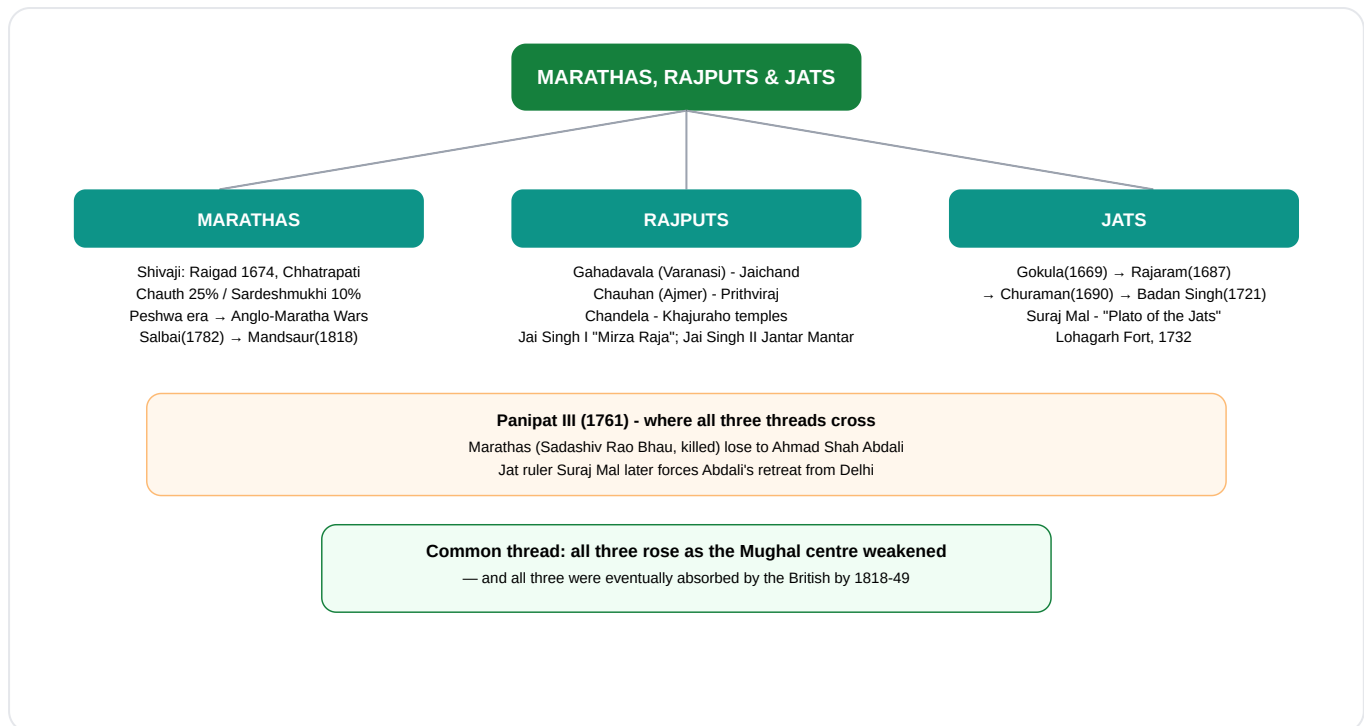
- **Suraj Mal** is remembered as the "**Plato of the Jat tribe**" for his political wisdom.
- He built **Lohagarh Fort** in Bharatpur, Rajasthan, commissioned in **1732**.
- Suraj Mal died in **December 1763**, in a battle near the **Hindan river**. The Mughal noble who was the dominant power at Delhi at that time was **Najib-ud-Daulah**.

Homework question from the lecture: Which Jat sardar, son of Suraj Mal, briefly captured Delhi? The standard answer is **Jawahar Singh**, who raided/held Delhi in 1764 — worth confirming against your specific exam's answer key, since the lecture leaves this open as homework.

17 Master Reference Table

Superlative / Record	Answer
Chauth rate	25%
Sardeshmukhi rate	10%
Treaty giving Marathas full control of Malwa	Treaty of Doraha, 1738
Ended 1st Anglo-Maratha War	Treaty of Salbai, 1782
Ended 3rd Anglo-Maratha War (Holkars)	Treaty of Mandsaur, 1818
Shivaji's coronation / title / place	1674 / Chhatrapati / Raigad
Shivaji's first fort	Torna (Prachandgad)
Died defending Sinhagad (1670)	Tanaji Malusare
First Peshwa	Balaji Vishwanath, 1713
Last Peshwa	Bajirao II
Died at Panipat III commanding the Marathas	Sadashiv Rao Bhau
"Mirza Raja" title	Jai Singh I (by Shah Jahan)
Built Kumbhalgarh Fort / "Sangeetraj"	Rana Kumbha, 1469
Named Jaipur the "Pink City"	Queen Mary, 1911
Founded the Bharatpur Jat kingdom	Churaman & Badan Singh
"Plato of the Jat tribe"	Suraj Mal
Built Lohagarh Fort	Suraj Mal, 1732

18 Mind Map — Marathas, Rajputs & Jats



19 30-Second Revision

Fact	Value
Chauth / Sardeshmukhi	25% / 10%
Treaty of Doraha	1738 — Marathas gain Malwa
Anglo-Maratha Wars	1775-82 / 1803-05 / 1817-19
Shivaji's coronation	1674, Raigad, by Gaga Bhatt
Panipat III	1761 — Abdali defeats Marathas (Sadashiv Rao Bhau killed)
Bharatpur Jat kingdom founders	Churaman & Badan Singh
"Plato of the Jats"	Suraj Mal
Khajuraho builders	Chandela (Rajput) dynasty

20 PYQs from the Video (with Answers)

- 1. What was Chauth, and on whom was it imposed?**
Ans: A 25% tax the Marathas imposed on neighbouring kingdoms
- 2. Which 1738 treaty gave the Marathas full control of Malwa and suppressed the Nizam?**
Ans: Treaty of Doraha (Bhopal)
- 3. Which Anglo-Maratha War resulted in Peshwa territories merging into the Bombay Presidency?**
Ans: The Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817–19)
- 4. When did Shivaji receive the title of Chhatrapati?**
Ans: 1674
- 5. Which Maratha family does Chhatrapati Shivaji belong to?**
Ans: Bhonsle

6. Who performed Shivaji's coronation?

Ans: Gaga Bhatt

7. Who defeated the combined Peshwa-Scindia forces in 1801?

Ans: Yashwant Rao Holkar

8. What was Sardeshmukhi under Maratha administration?

Ans: A 10% tax on revenue

9. What was the title of the Maratha "Prime Minister"?

Ans: Peshwa

10. Which Maratha warrior died defending Sinhagad Fort against the Mughals?

Ans: Tanaji Malusare

11. What was Shivaji's royal cavalry called?

Ans: Bargir

12. Which treaty was signed in 1818 between the British and the Holkar chiefs, ending the Third Anglo-Maratha War?

Ans: Treaty of Mandsaur

13. In which city did Shivaji establish the Maratha Empire's capital in 1674?

Ans: Raigad

14. Which fort is considered the "first pillar" of the Maratha Empire?

Ans: Torna (Prachandgad)

15. With whom did Shivaji sign the Treaty of Purandar (1665)?

Ans: Raja Jai Singh I

16. Which Ashta Pradhan minister was in charge of finance?

Ans: Amatya

17. In which fort was Shivaji imprisoned after fleeing Mughal custody?

Ans: Agra

18. What was Shivaji's capital, and where was his formal coronation held?

Ans: Raigad (both)

19. Who were Shivaji's gurus?

Ans: Dada Konddev (uncle) and Samarth Ramdas

20. In which Maratha administration did the Ashta Pradhan council exist?

Ans: Shivaji's

21. What did the "Sar-e-Naubat" role relate to in Shivaji's time?

Ans: Senior administrative/military head (Senapati-like role)

22. Which Ashta Pradhan member handled foreign affairs?

Ans: Sumant

23. Who simplified/made effective Maratha rule after Sambhaji?

Ans: Rajaram (I)

24. What is the correct order of Peshwas: Bajirao, Balaji Bajirao, Balaji Vishwanath, Madhavrao?

Ans: Balaji Vishwanath → Bajirao → Balaji Bajirao → Madhavrao

25. Statement-reason: by 1750 the Maratha empire was a Peshwa-led confederacy, and Shahu's successors depended on Peshwa wishes — true?

Ans: Both true; reason correctly explains the statement

26. In whose reign did the Marathas become insignificant and the Peshwas the real rulers?

Ans: After the death of Chhatrapati Shahu, 1749

27. Who held Maratha leadership at the time of Aurangzeb's death (1707)? (open/homework question)

Ans: Not explicitly resolved in the lecture — commonly attributed to Rajaram's regime/Tarabai as regent for young Shivaji II around this period; verify against your specific source

28. Whom did Indira Kanwar marry (recheck from Part 3)?

Ans: Farrukhsiyar (not Muhammad Shah — see Part 3 correction)

29. Who helped Prince Ajit Singh regain the kingdom of Jodhpur?

Ans: Durgadas Rathore

30. Which Rajput dynasty had its capital at Varanasi?

Ans: Gahadavala

31. Which dynasty and ruler built the Khajuraho temples (950–1050 CE)?

Ans: Chandela (Rajput) dynasty

32. Who gave Jai Singh I the title "Mirza Raja"?

Ans: Shah Jahan

33. Which Mewar ruler is known as "Sangeetraj" and built Kumbhalgarh Fort?

Ans: Rana Kumbha

34. In 950–1050 CE, which dynasty's ruler built the Khajuraho temples in Madhya Pradesh?

Ans: Chandela dynasty (Rajput)

35. Regarding Jai Singh II's astronomical work: did he build his own telescope?

Ans: No — he only imported/procured telescopes and De La Hire's tables from Europe

36. At which location did Jai Singh II NOT build a Jantar Mantar?

Ans: Agra

37. Who founded the Bharatpur Jat kingdom (1790, per this lecture)?

Ans: Churaman and Badan Singh

38. Correct order of early Jat leaders (18th century)?

Ans: Gokula → Rajaram → Churaman → Badan Singh

39. Where did Gokula Jat revolt against the Mughals in the 17th century?

Ans: Tilpat (Battle of Tilpat)

40. Who is called the "Plato of the Jat tribe"?

Ans: Suraj Mal

41. Who built Lohagarh Fort in Bharatpur, commissioned in 1732?

Ans: Suraj Mal

42. Who was the dominant Mughal noble when Suraj Mal died in December 1763?

Ans: Najib-ud-Daulah

21 Extra Practice (Beyond the Video)

E1. Which battle (1737) directly preceded and forced the Treaty of Doraha?

Ans: Battle of Bhopal

E2. Who was the Peshwa during the Battle of Bhopal and Treaty of Doraha?

Ans: Bajirao I

E3. Who was Suraj Mal's son, credited with a brief raid/capture of Delhi in 1764?

Ans: Jawahar Singh

E4. Which title did Aurangzeb give Jai Singh II, distinct from Jai Singh I's "Mirza Raja"?

Ans: "Sawai" — hence "Sawai Jai Singh"

E5. What was the earlier Battle of Palkhed (1728) significant for?

Ans: Bajirao I's manoeuvre-warfare victory over the Nizam, forcing the Treaty of Mungi Shevgaon (recognising Shahu and Maratha tax rights in the Deccan)

22 Bonus — Standard-Syllabus Points (Not in the Video)

Commonly tested alongside "Marathas, Rajputs and Jats" but not explicitly covered in the lecture. Verified against standard references.

- **Battle of Palkhed (1728):** Bajirao I's tactical masterpiece against Nizam-ul-Mulk, ending in the Treaty of Mungi Shevgaon — often studied as a classic example of manoeuvre warfare, and a natural companion fact to the Treaty of Doraha (1738).
- **Battle of Haldighati (1576) & Battle of Dewar (1582):** Maharana Pratap's two most-tested battles against Akbar's forces (Haldighati was inconclusive; Dewar was a clear Rajput victory) — useful context for the "Rajputs" portion of this chapter.
- **Rani Chennamma of Kittur (1824):** An early Rajput/regional-ruler resistance episode against the British, useful as a bridge to the "resistance before 1857" theme (see Part 2's bonus section).
- **Treaty of Bassein (1802):** Signed by Peshwa Bajirao II, accepting a Subsidiary Alliance with the British — the direct trigger for the Second Anglo-Maratha War, worth knowing alongside the treaties listed above.

Cross-check all dates with your NCERT Class VII "Our Past II" and Class VIII/XII sources for the standard textbook framing.

This is **Part 4** of an **8-part** series covering the full lecture. The Indian National Congress is covered next in **Part 5**.